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Dh200,000
fine, jail for
spreading
fake news

ABU DHABI
BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

A minimum sentence of one year in prison and a fine of no less than Dh100,000 awaits anyone who uses digital tools to spread false or provocative content that contradicts official statements or incites public anxiety, harms national interests, or disrupts public order and health.

A warning to this effect was issued to the public by the Abu Dhabi Judicial Department (ADJD) and the Abu Dhabi Police yesterday.

The penalties escalate significantly in aggravated cases. If the false content stirs public unrest against state institutions or occurs during a crisis, epidemic, or emergency, the punishment increases to a minimum of two years in prison and a fine of at least Dh200,000.

Article 52 of Federal Decree-Law No 34 of 2021 also criminalises using digital bots to spread false information, as well as hosting or managing websites involved in human trafficking or promoting firearms.

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Aid remains a far cry
for starving Gazans

UAE MOVES TO ADDRESS FOOD NEEDS OF 15,000 CIVILIANS



AFF

■ Palestinian children line up to receive a hot meal at a food distribution point in the Al Rimal neighbourhood of Gaza City in the central Gaza Strip yesterday.

GAZA

Palestinians in Gaza are still waiting for aid to arrive after Israel eased an 11-week blockade on Sunday, according to the BBC.

Israeli officials said 93 trucks entered Gaza on Tuesday but the UN says its teams have not yet been able to distribute aid.

UNRWA, the UN's Palestinian refugee agency, says supplies "sit waiting" in a warehouse just a few hours' drive from Gaza. Jens Laerke, the spokesperson for the UN's humanitarian agency, said no trucks were picked up from the Gaza side of Kerem Shalom, the Israeli border crossing with southern Gaza.

UN spokesperson Stéphane Dujarric said Tuesday that although the aid had entered Gaza, aid workers were not able to bring it to distribution points, after the Israeli military forced them to reload the supplies onto separate trucks and workers ran out of time.

First phase of UAE aid

Meanwhile, Shaikh Abdulrahman Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, held a phone call with Gideon Sa'ar, Minister of Foreign Affairs of Israel, which led to an agreement to allow the delivery of urgent humanitarian aid from the UAE. The aid will address the food needs of approximately 15,000 civilians in the Gaza Strip in the initial phase.

Israeli strikes continued to pound the Gaza Strip yesterday, despite a surge in international anger at Israel's widening offensive. The attacks killed at least 82 people, including several women and a week-old infant, according to the Gaza Health Ministry and area hospitals.

A few dozen Israeli activists opposed to Israel's decision to allow aid into Gaza while Hamas still holds Israeli hostages attempted to block trucks carrying supplies yesterday morning, but were kept back by Israeli police. A group of diplomats also came under fire while visiting Jenin, a city in the Israel-occupied West Bank, according to the Palestinian Authority.

— Agencies
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